Ankit Khatiwada

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Research Interests

Computer vision and vision-language models, in particular how large pretrained models generalize, how robust they are, and how their behavior can be interpreted. An interest that grew out of High-Level Computer Vision. I am also interested in applied machine learning for sports analytics and in computer networks.

Education

M.Sc. in Computer Science *April 2026 - Present*
Saarland Informatics Campus, Saarland University *Saarbrücken, Germany*

- **Grade: 1.7**
- Focus areas: Data Networks, Computer Vision, and Sports Analytics.
- Relevant coursework: *High-Level Computer Vision*, *Machine Learning*, and *Neural Networks*.

B.Eng. in Computer Engineering *August 2018 - May 2023*
Kathmandu University *Dhulikhel, Nepal*

- **CGPA: 3.90 / 4.0** **German Grade: 1.2**
- Relevant coursework: *Artificial Intelligence*, *Statistics*, *Algorithms and Data Structures*, and *Database Management*.

Professional Experience

Ycotek *July 2025 - January 2026*
AI Engineer (NLP and Large Language Models) *Kathmandu, Nepal*

- Developed NLP components and LLM-powered application pipelines, working across prompt engineering, retrieval, and evaluation of model outputs.
- Designed and iterated on prompting and evaluation strategies to improve the reliability of LLM responses on domain-specific tasks.
- Built data-processing and analysis pipelines in Python to prepare and curate datasets for downstream model use.

LIS Nepal Pvt. Ltd. *January 2024 - July 2025*
Software Engineer (LLM-Powered Products) *Kathmandu, Nepal*

- Contributed to the development of LLM-powered products, integrating language-model APIs into production systems and shaping their data flows.
- Performed data validation and quality checks on an existing data warehouse supporting analytics and reporting.
- Built interactive data-visualisation tools (D3.js, Vega) to explore and communicate model- and data-driven insights.

Cedar Gate Technologies *April 2023 - September 2023*
Intern and Associate Data Engineer *Lalitpur, Nepal*

- Automated data cleaning and transformation with Python and SQL, reducing manual effort by 20–50%.
- Improved ETL pipeline performance by 10–30% through query optimisation and modular pipeline design.

Teaching Experience

Matlab and Data Analysis (MD-PhD Program) *September - October 2026*
Tutor *Saarland University (Online)*

- Served as tutor for the interactive online course *Matlab and Data Analysis* led by Prof. Dr. Marcel Lauterbach, open as a Global Classroom to students of partner universities.
- Supported students with the daily in-class assignments in MATLAB, helping them work through exercises and resolve problems during the sessions.
- Handled organizational matters for the professor throughout the course.

Projects

Data Mining and Classification Visualiser *Personal Project*
Python, Machine Learning, Data Visualisation *GitHub*

github.com/ch-ankit/data-mining-classification

- Built an interactive tool that trains classification models and visualises their behaviour (decision boundaries, confusion matrices), making model diagnostics interpretable.

Personal Medical Report Management System *Personal Project*
Python, NLP, SQL *GitHub*

github.com/ch-ankit/Manage-Personal-Health-Data

- Designed a system for structuring and managing personal medical records, applying text-processing techniques to extract and organise information from unstructured reports.

Technical Skills

- **Machine Learning / Deep Learning:** PyTorch, scikit-learn, NumPy, pandas.
- **NLP / LLMs:** Language-model APIs, prompt engineering, output evaluation.
- **Computer Vision:** High-Level Computer Vision (coursework), image classification, vision-language concepts.
- **Programming:** Python, SQL, TypeScript, JavaScript, MATLAB.
- **Data & Tooling:** ETL pipelines, dbt, data visualisation (D3.js, Vega), Git, GitHub, Linux.

Certifications and Languages

- **Certifications:** AI Fundamentals (DataCamp), dbt Fundamentals (dbt Labs).
- **Languages:** English (C1), German (A2), Nepali (native).